

NO GRAND PLAN, JUST BUILD

ACHINA MAYYA ON STARTING SMALL AND SCALING FAST

For Achina Mayya, the creator's journey didn't begin with a breakthrough vision but a simple instinct to build. "It wasn't a grand calling. It started because I wanted to build something together with my husband, Varun," she says. What followed was a scrappy start – shooting videos from her apartment, juggling a day job, and learning by doing. From one imperfect video to building a 500-person GenAI media company!

How would you describe the brand of content you create?

AevyTV is hard to put in a box, and I think that's partly intentional. We sit somewhere between storytelling and information but what actually defines us is that we treat every video as a visual experience, not just a container for data. We cover topics ranging from technology, social and cultural issues, stories that matter to young Indians. But what's unique isn't the subject matter, it's more the refusal to be surface-level and boring.

What do people not understand about being a creator?

Almost everything is a people problem. I don't mean that cynically,

I mean it's actually the most interesting part. Growing an audience, building a team, staying relevant, managing quality under pressure, at every stage, it comes down to understanding humans. The other thing nobody tells you: it's a team sport. The myth of the solo creator doing everything is mostly just that – a myth. And a harmful one, because it makes new creators feel like they're failing when they can't do it all alone. And then there's the consistency grind, which is the most unglamorous part of this job.

Is your content creation centered around a mission?

The mission is simple: help young Indians make better decisions. About life, work, money, understanding the world they're actually living in. There are many young people in India now, and through our content if I can contribute even a little – a better decision, a career opportunity, a shot at social mobility that feels worth working towards.

The ripple effect I'm most proud of is the video editing school. Many of our early students came straight from our channel – old subscribers who joined Aevy Video School and then got jobs as editors. Some of

them are running 10-15 man teams now. And we're just getting started.

Your advice for creators chasing revenue vs creating a unique voice?

In my early days I made content I personally wanted to watch. That's not wrong, but it's incomplete. The breakthrough was reframing it: content isn't just self-expression, it's also a product. So treat it like one. Find a gap. Bring a specific point of view, your format, your storytelling, your experience, something that's specifically yours. Then ask whether enough people actually want that thing. If yes, you have something. If not, iterate before you invest another year in the wrong direction.

What's your perspective on AI in content creation?

AI does more heavy lifting in short-form, where speed and consistency are the priority. In long-form, where we're really pushing the storytelling, it's still mostly manual. For any creator: use AI to eliminate the things that eat your time without requiring your creativity, research, shoot briefs, generating visual options, great. The parts where your specific perspective and taste are the actual product, don't outsource that. **d**